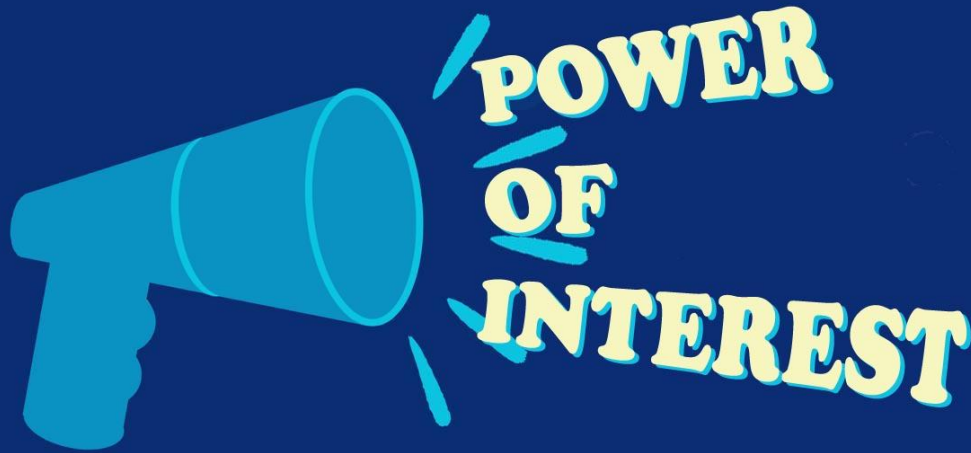




Simple Mechanisms

Week 2, Term 1
POI

Agenda

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This House Would ban the use of AI in schools

Definitions

- Introduced by the PM
- Challenged by the LO
- Clarification of key terms within the motion
- Cannot be excessively narrow, but can be used to gain a slight advantage over other teams

Rebuttals

Purpose

Provide a response to another team's arguments.

Logically break down their argument.

Example

The PM says:

"AI should be banned in schools because it prevents the development of skills like critical thinking."

The LO rebuts:

"Using AI correctly is an important skill in itself which should be taught in school, which is growing increasingly relevant and useful."

Tips

Keep it concise but clear. Ensure your rebuttal follows a clear logical argument.

Rebuttal is less important than introducing a new point/extension/weighing, so it should up less time in your speech than those things.

POI - Point of Information

What is a POI

A question given by the opposing bench in the debate.

How to give a POI

Must be a question, not a statement.
No longer than 15 seconds.
Given to the opposing bench.
The speaker will be given the choice to accept or decline.
You must not respond to the speaker
i.e. no back and forth discussion.

How to take a POI

You may either accept or decline.
If you do answer, do not over elaborate and waste your time.
If you don't know the answer, say your partner will take care of it.
If the answer to your question is in your following point, say that you will answer the question in your speech.

Chains of Analysis

How to make a chain of analysis:

- start with an assertion
- try and ask 'why' or 'how'
- imagine you are explaining your point to a small child

Assertions vs arguments

Assertion: If we ban AI, students will have better writing and thinking skills

Argument:

1. If we ban AI use in school & for schoolwork,
2. students will be forced to develop their own ideas
3. and they will must be able to convey their ideas on paper by themselves
4. which will give them more practice in thinking and writing
5. more practice in thinking and writing means they will be better at thinking and writing
6. therefore banning AI will lead to better thinking and writing skills

Using a chain of analysis leads to a clearer explanation of why you are right, which enables the judge to believe what you are saying.

It is difficult to believe an assertion, because of the lack of explanation as to why that is the case.

Signposting

Phrases to use for signposting:

- My first piece of rebuttal...
- My first point is...
- My second point is...
- My third point is...
- I will start with some framing...
- Therefore, in conclusion...
- To summarise our side...

Example Outline:

“I will begin my speech first by rebutting X, before explaining my three major points for why (MOTION).”

Signposting is basically waving a big flag in your speech and saying ‘this is where I’m at’.

Signposting is an incredibly necessary tool, because without these indications of where you are in your argument, it is very easy to get lost in your speech.

Using these simple signposts indicate to the judge the start/end of your point, making it easier to digest and understand.

Another thing you may want to do is have an outline at the start of your speech.

This is basically you declaring what you will do in your speech.

Questions?

